

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

2026-10-09 · Morning edition · Issued 07:00 CDT

Houthi Airport Strikes Kill Three Saudis in Riyadh; Saudi Retaliation Hits Sanaa

- Saudi Arabia's civil aviation authority said on Friday that three Saudi nationals were killed and several people of various nationalities injured in two attacks on King Khalid International Airport on Thursday. — [Reuters](#)
- The first attack targeted airport facilities; the second struck a Saudia Airlines aircraft, and one of the dead was a Saudia pilot, the airline confirmed. — [Reuters](#)
- The Houthis said they attacked Riyadh airport with two cruise missiles and also struck Najran airport and King Khalid Air Base; Saudi Arabia said it intercepted and destroyed two ballistic missiles toward Riyadh, with falling debris damaging a kindergarten and a medical clinic. The weapon types are contested. — [CNN](#)
- Lufthansa Group, Air India and two other carriers suspended flights to Riyadh; the U.S. Mission in Saudi Arabia warned Americans of escalation risk, and U.S. government employees now need special authorization to use the airport. — [Reuters](#)
- Saudi Arabia retaliated overnight with airstrikes on Houthi targets in Sanaa; the coalition said it destroyed three missile launch platforms and warned of a firm response to civilian targeting. — [Reuters](#)
- In a televised speech Thursday, Houthi leader Abdul-Malik al-Houthi vowed to continue the attacks and warned workers at Saudi oil facilities to avoid potential targets. — [CNN](#)

Iran Vows to Block New Oil Routes as US Sanctions 17 Shadow-Fleet Vessels

- A senior regional official close to Tehran told Reuters that Iran's political leaders and the IRGC agreed on a plan to treat any new oil-export route not authorized by Iran as hostile, with tactics including missile and drone attacks on ships or boats to scare them away. — [Reuters](#)
- The Antigua and Barbuda-flagged chemical tanker Acers was struck by multiple projectiles around 1900 UTC on October 7, about 51 nautical miles north of Madinat ash Shamal, Qatar, with minor crew injuries reported — the first deep-Gulf strike in weeks. — [Reuters](#)
- The U.S. Navy-led Joint Maritime Information Centre recorded at least 12 attacks on oil, LNG and LPG tankers from September 28 to October 5, the highest weekly tally since the war began. — [Reuters](#)
- The U.S. Treasury on Thursday sanctioned 17 vessels under 'Operation Economic Outcast' for transporting Iranian crude, oil products and petrochemicals; a Treasury official said the move 'neutralizes the vast majority' of the Iranian shadow fleet. — [Reuters](#)
- Treasury said Iran has only about 20 million barrels of crude left on vessels outside the blockade, off Singapore, Malaysia and China, and has stopped loading and offloading tankers; Secretary Bessent named the Panama-flagged Starway, which he said has carried more than three million barrels of Iranian naphtha since 2025. — [Reuters](#)

Trump Rules Out Pre-Midterm Strikes; Iran Reviews US Response

- President Trump said Thursday that the United States is having 'productive discussions' with Iran, will not attack Iran before the November 3 midterm elections, and will keep the naval blockade 'in full force and effect'. — [Reuters](#)
- Trump asserted that 22 million barrels of oil flowed through the Strait of Hormuz in a single night with 'not one barrel coming from, or going to, Iran'; Kpler estimates crude crossing the strait fell 27 percent to about 10.1 million barrels a day, roughly three-quarters of its pre-war level. The figures are contested. — [Reuters](#)
- Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said on October 8 that Tehran is reviewing the U.S. response to its seven-day Hormuz-reopening proposal and will deliver a reply 'within the next few days,' with the indirect negotiating process continuing through mediators. Reported but unconfirmed. — [Reuters](#)
- About a dozen U.S. Navy ships are in Middle East waters enforcing the blockade, the Wall Street Journal reported. — [WSJ](#)

Markets

- Brent traded around \$102.84 a barrel on October 9, easing after President Trump said the United States would not attack Iran before the November midterms. — [Reuters](#)
- WTI traded around \$90.54 a barrel on October 9, down roughly half a percent in early trading. — [Reuters](#)
- The 10-year Treasury yield stood at 5.23 percent on October 8, steadying just below Wednesday's 24-year high of 5.364 percent. — [Reuters](#)
- VLCC charters for U.S. Gulf-to-China November loadings hit \$80 million this week, putting delivered costs near \$40 a barrel against \$8.60 before the war, shipbroker data via LSEG showed. — [Reuters](#)
- Hurricane Isaias forced U.S. Gulf of Mexico producers to shut in about 1.3 million barrels a day, 62.9 percent of current output, as of Thursday, the U.S. Marine Minerals Administration said. — [Reuters](#)

Sources: [Reuters](#) · [CNN](#) · [Reuters](#) · [Reuters](#) · [Reuters](#) · [Reuters](#) · [WSJ](#) · [Reuters](#) · [Reuters](#)
 Compiled from X posts and traditional news outlets. Verify before acting on any single report.